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**Revision Date:**
October 01, 2025

**Background:**
Employment Services (ES) participants must be assigned to activities leading to self-sufficiency through employment, education and/or training. These activities are assigned through an ES plan using the Welfare-To-Work Plan Activity Assignment (WTW 2) form after the participant's initial engagement. Per state regulations, an ES plan must include activities and services designed to remove barriers to participation and employment leading to self-sufficiency.

**Purpose:**
The purpose of this revision is to provide guidance on ES plan requirements for Student Training and Education Program (STEP) participants attending publicly funded or nonprofit postsecondary educational institutions per Senate Bill (SB) 768.

**Policy:**
Assessment
ES participants will be assessed for the following items when developing an ES plan:
- Work history and job readiness
- Education level and vocational interest and goals
- Learning Disabilities (LD)
- Mental Health, Substance Use Disorder, Domestic Violence
- Basic reading/math competencies
- English language skills
- Local labor market conditions
- Other needs, such as Family Stabilization and Housing

**Procedure:**
Timeframe
All non-exempt customers are required to sign an ES plan within 90 calendar days of whichever occurs first: the completion of initial Job Search or other initial engagement activities, the date the customer's eligibility for cash aid is determined, or the date the customer is required to participate in ES.

The 90-day period to develop an ES plan does not include the time that a participant spends in good cause determination, compliance or sanction curing processes, or time between the date an LD evaluation appointment is scheduled and the date the final report is received (up to a maximum of 90 days). The 90-day period will resume after the final report from the LD evaluator is received, or on the 91st day if the final report has not been received.

All participants are required to sign an ES plan except participants who are assigned to initial engagement activities as referenced in Processing Guide 10-005.E1.

Elements of the ES Plan
All ES plans will include the following:
- Participation status

- Total hourly requirements
- Activities, location, schedule and hours
- Date when participation verification is due
- Standards for maintaining satisfactory progress
- ES supportive services, including accommodations
- Participant's certification, including rights and responsibilities
- Date to change terms of the ES Plan
- Participant and Employment Case Manager (ECM) signature/date

Change to an ES Plan
Any time there is a change in a participant's current activity, a new ES plan is required.

Participants have:
- 30 days from the beginning of their initial ES activity to request a change or reassignment to another activity
  **Note:** This is only available once in a lifetime to each participant
- 3 business days after signing an ES plan to evaluate and request changes to the terms of the plan

If the participant and the ECM are unable to reach an agreement on the ES plan, the matter must be referred to a Third-Party Assessor for a review of the participant's assessment and ES plan. Prior to making the third-party referral, the ECM must contact their assigned Self-Sufficiency Services (SSS) Program Specialist to review the request and the ES plan to ensure the plan is suitable for the participant's self-sufficiency goals.

The ECM is required to contact the participant and schedule an appointment to complete a reassessment prior to the expiration of the current ES plan. The ECM will document all efforts to contact the participant and attempt to conduct the reassessment to avoid gaps in services.

Backdating of an ES Plan
Backdating of an ES activity start date on the WTW 2 is only allowed when a participant contacts the ECM timely to report new employment or a new educational activity and:
- The participant is unable to attend an appointment to complete a WTW 2 due to work or school schedule conflicts
- The ECM does not follow-up with the participant timely and the WTW 2 is not signed within the appropriate time frames due to ECM error

Limited and Non-English-Speaking Participants
The ES plan must be provided in a language that is understood by the participant. When the ES plan is not available in the participant's preferred language, bilingual staff or interpreter services must be provided. Use of bilingual staff or interpreter services during the development of the ES plan must be clearly documented in a journal entry.

Enrollment in **Publicly Funded or Nonprofit** Postsecondary Education

ES participants enrolled in publicly funded or nonprofit postsecondary educational institutions are required to sign a WTW 2 plan each semester/quarter to receive supportive services. If enrollment verification is obtained, the ECM will develop/sign the WTW 2 plan with the participant and issue an Advance Standard Payment (ASP) at least 10 calendar days prior to the beginning of the academic period.

If enrollment verification is not obtained at least 10 calendar days prior to the beginning of the academic period, the ECM will develop/sign the WTW 2 plan with the participant and issue an ASP no later than 10 calendar days from the date of receipt of all required items.

If the participant provided school enrollment verification and the WTW 2 plan is not developed/signed timely with the participant for the next academic period, an ASP will be issued to the participant. The ECM will follow-up with the participant regarding the development and signing of any ES plans as required. See Processing Guide 10-011.A2 Ancillary Supportive Services for information regarding ASP and reimbursements.

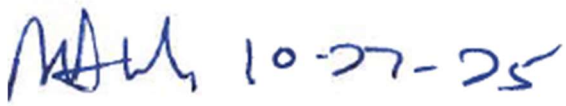
**Important:** The ECM will discuss the importance of reporting school enrollment as soon as possible with the participant to ensure timely issuance of an ASP and successful participation.

**Procedure:**
Processing Guide 10-005.G1

**References:**
Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) 42-711.4-.8, 42-714.2, 42.750.2-.4
All County Information Notices (ACIN) 1-03-19
All County Letter (ACL) 15-80, 20-120, 21-04, 21-75E, 22-80, 24-32

**Sunset Date:**
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by October 31, 2028.

**Approval for Release:**



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services